

much more informal, and is expressed in ordinary lay language. The effect of the two styles mixed together in the one sentence is a feeling of incongruity—which was presumably not intended by the author or authors. This example, however, is unusual in its brevity. More often, the problem of inconsistency emerges only over longer stretches of text, especially where the granularity of the multiple authorship is at the paragraph, section, or chapter level.

This should give you an idea of what exactly we're referring to when we mean inconsistency in style.

3.3 What To Blog About

The first consideration here is whether you want to report on what's going on all over the Internet, that is, regurgitating content, or whether you want to churn out original content.

The former isn't as bad as it sounds—"regurgitated" is just the technical word we're using. It essentially means you're aggregating content and links, with some of your own commentary, of course. What gets created is one place for people with a particular interest to visit, instead of them going about all over the Net looking for the interesting stuff. What will be the personal and distinguishing aspect here is, of course, your commentary: a blog that just aggregates can be pretty boring. Besides, it will not have an identity.

If you're planning on writing original stuff, amongst other things, you should be a good writer. That's about all we can say here. Do some introspection and self-analysis: are you a good writer? Ask your friends—close ones, who'll tell you the truth—do *they* think you're a good writer? It's a bad idea to jump into original writing without some writing flair and experience. The idea of a blog of your own—with entirely your writing on it—may seem very appealing indeed, but it will be just lost in the clutter if you're not what people call a good writer. Naturally, you can